

Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon

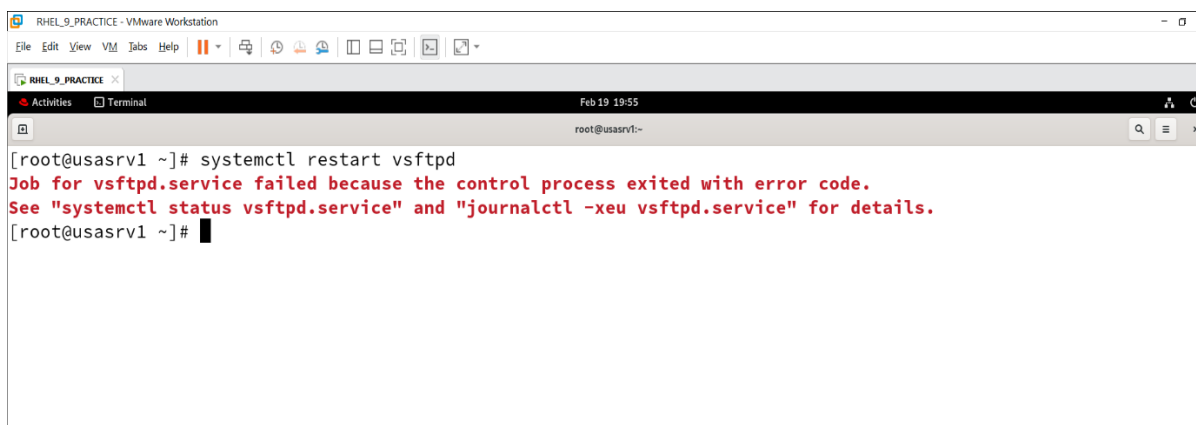
Problem Statement

During restarting the vsftpd service in RHEL 9 error occurred

Error-

Job for vsftpd.service failed because the control process exited with error code.

See "systemctl status vsftpd.service" and "journalctl -xeu vsftpd.service" for details.

A screenshot of a terminal window titled "RHEL_9_PRACTICE - VMware Workstation". The terminal shows the command `systemctl restart vsftpd` being executed. The output is a red error message: `Job for vsftpd.service failed because the control process exited with error code. See "systemctl status vsftpd.service" and "journalctl -xeu vsftpd.service" for details.` The prompt is `[root@usasrv1 ~]#`.

```
[root@usasrv1 ~]# systemctl restart vsftpd
Job for vsftpd.service failed because the control process exited with error code.
See "systemctl status vsftpd.service" and "journalctl -xeu vsftpd.service" for details.
[root@usasrv1 ~]#
```

The above screenshot shows the exact error that occur after restarting vsftpd service

DIAGNOSIS:-

1. As first we checked the status of vsftpd service

```
RHEL_9_PRACTICE - VMware Workstation
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RHEL_9_PRACTICE
Activities Terminal Feb 19 20:05
root@usasrv1:~

[root@usasrv1 ~]# systemctl status vsftpd.
Unit vsftpd.service could not be found.
[root@usasrv1 ~]# systemctl status vsftpd
* vsftpd.service - Vsftpd ftp daemon
   Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/vsftpd.service; enabled; preset: disabled)
   Active: failed (Result: exit-code) since Thu 2026-02-19 19:54:01 IST; 11min ago
  Duration: 1min 39.595s
   Process: 4328 ExecStart=/usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf (code=exited, status=2)
    CPU: 12ms

Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1.radical.com systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1.radical.com vsftpd[4328]: 500 OOPS: bad bool value in config file for: listen
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1.radical.com systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Control process exited, code=exited, status=2/INVALIDARGUMENT
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1.radical.com systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Failed with result 'exit-code'.
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1.radical.com systemd[1]: Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon.
[root@usasrv1 ~]#
```

2. Then Checked logs – journalctl -xe and /var/log/messages and man 5 vsftpd.conf

```
RHEL_9_PRACTICE - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
RHEL_9_PRACTICE
Activities Terminal Feb 19 20:00
root@usasrv1:~

Feb 19 19:42:25 usasrv1 journal[2158]: unable to get EDID for xrandr-Virtual-1: unable to get EDID for output
Feb 19 19:42:29 usasrv1 journal[2158]: unable to get EDID for xrandr-Virtual-1: unable to get EDID for output
Feb 19 19:43:14 usasrv1 systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 19 19:43:14 usasrv1 vsftpd[4246]: 500 OOPS: bad bool value in config file for: listen
Feb 19 19:43:14 usasrv1 systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Control process exited, code=exited, status=2/INVALIDARGUMENT
Feb 19 19:43:14 usasrv1 systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Failed with result 'exit-code'.
Feb 19 19:43:14 usasrv1 systemd[1]: Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon.
Feb 19 19:43:43 usasrv1 NetworkManager[850]: <info> [1771510423.9694] dhcp4 (ens160): state changed new lease, address=192.168.163.129
Feb 19 19:51:19 usasrv1 systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 19 19:51:19 usasrv1 vsftpd[4294]: 500 OOPS: bad bool value in config file for: listen
Feb 19 19:51:19 usasrv1 systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Control process exited, code=exited, status=2/INVALIDARGUMENT
Feb 19 19:51:19 usasrv1 systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Failed with result 'exit-code'.
Feb 19 19:51:19 usasrv1 systemd[1]: Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon.
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1 systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1 vsftpd[4328]: 500 OOPS: bad bool value in config file for: listen
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1 systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Control process exited, code=exited, status=2/INVALIDARGUMENT
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1 systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Failed with result 'exit-code'.
Feb 19 19:54:01 usasrv1 systemd[1]: Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon.
Feb 19 19:57:41 usasrv1 cupsd[856]: REQUEST localhost - - "POST / HTTP/1.1" 200 183 Renew-Subscription successful-ok
Feb 19 19:58:43 usasrv1 NetworkManager[850]: <info> [1771511323.9708] dhcp4 (ens160): state changed new lease, address=192.168.163.129
```

3. Got the same error in both status and logs that
Error- 500 OOPS: bad bool value in config file for: listen
4. With the help of chatgpt cross checked the error by the below command
/usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf

SOLUTION

- As we open this file with vi editor
- vi [/etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf](#)
- changes done in the above file

1. we commented existing setting line number 114 & 123 as it was not working so made demarcation for future convenience and added two new settings
2. listen=NO
3. listen_ipv6=YES

- settings modified can be seen in below screenshot

```
105 # You may activate the "-R" option to the builtin ls. This is disabled by
106 # default to avoid remote users being able to cause excessive I/O on large
107 # sites. However, some broken FTP clients such as "ncftp" and "mirror" assume
108 # the presence of the "-R" option, so there is a strong case for enabling it.
109 #ls_recurse_enable=YES
110 #
111 # When "listen" directive is enabled, vsftpd runs in standalone mode and
112 # listens on IPv4 sockets. This directive cannot be used in conjunction
113 # with the listen_ipv6 directive.
114 #listen=NO
115 #
116 # This directive enables listening on IPv6 sockets. By default, listening
117 # on the IPv6 "any" address (:::) will accept connections from both IPv6
118 # and IPv4 clients. It is not necessary to listen on *both* IPv4 and IPv6
119 # sockets. If you want that (perhaps because you want to listen on specific
120 # addresses) then you must run two copies of vsftpd with two configuration
121 # files.
122 # Make sure, that one of the listen options is commented !!
123 #listen_ipv6=YES
124 #*****settings done by harshvardhan *****
125 listen=YES
126 listen_ipv6=NO
127
128
129 pam_service_name=vsftpd
130 userlist_enable=YES
```

- At last restart vsftpd service
- Final image shows the service is active and working properly

RHEL_9_PRACTICE - VMware Workstation

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RHEL_9_PRACTICE

Activities Terminal Feb 19 20:24 root@usasrv1~

```
[root@usasrv1 ~]# systemctl restart vsftpd
[root@usasrv1 ~]# systemctl status vsftpd
● vsftpd.service - Vsftpd ftp daemon
   Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/vsftpd.service; enabled; preset: disabled)
   Active: active (running) since Thu 2026-02-19 20:24:39 IST; 10s ago
     Process: 4553 ExecStart=/usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf (code=exited, status=0/SUCCESS)
    Main PID: 4554 (vsftpd)
      Tasks: 1 (limit: 22879)
     Memory: 708.0K
        CPU: 5ms
    CGroup: /system.slice/vsftpd.service
            └─4554 /usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf

Feb 19 20:24:39 usasrv1.radical.com systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 19 20:24:39 usasrv1.radical.com systemd[1]: Started Vsftpd ftp daemon.
[root@usasrv1 ~]#
```

To direct input to this VM, click inside or press Ctrl+G.

31°C Mostly sunny

Search

ENG IN 14:55 19-02-2026